

Beyond Neptune

Surrounding the planets is the Kuiper Belt, a region of mainly icy-rocky bodies and a small number of dwarf planets, such as Pluto. Beyond this lies the Oort Cloud, a sphere of yet more ice bodies left over from the formation of the Solar System.

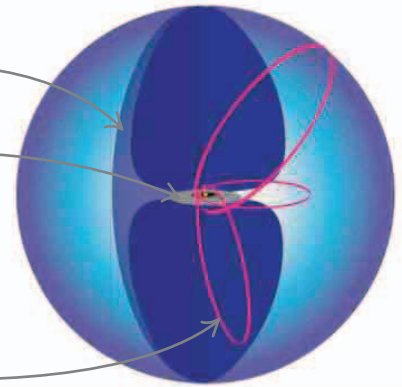
▷ The Oort Cloud

More than one trillion comets make up the Oort Cloud. Its outer edge marks the end of the Solar System.

The outer limit
The Oort Cloud reaches 50,000 AU from the Sun.

Kuiper Belt
The Kuiper Belt merges with the Oort Cloud.

Comet orbits
Many comets are ice bodies from the Oort Cloud that have been pushed into closer orbits around the Sun. They travel in all directions, as shown by the orbits in pink.



5. Jupiter

Diameter: 142,984 km (88,846 miles)
Distance from Sun: 5.2 AU
Year: 11.9 years
Day: 10 hours
Number of moons: 63
Cloud-top temperature: -108°C (-162°F)

6. Saturn

Diameter: 120,536 km (74,897 miles)
Distance from Sun: 9.6 AU
Year: 29.5 years
Day: 10.5 hours
Number of moons: 62
Cloud-top temperature: -139°C (-218°F)

7. Uranus

Diameter: 51,118 km (31,763 miles)
Distance from Sun: 19.2 AU
Year: 84 years
Day: 17 hours
Number of moons: 27
Cloud-top temperature: -197°C (-323°F)

8. Neptune

Diameter: 49,528 km (30,775 miles)
Distance from Sun: 30 AU
Year: 165 years
Day: 16 hours
Number of moons: 13
Cloud-top temperature: -201°C (-330°F)

